hybridity,' writes Singh, 'was a pervasive device in Indian painting and was the result of a conscious, willful, and self-reflexive choice.' Indeed, painters could, and did, use a variety of styles even within a single painting.

The scale and nascent ambition of the works undertaken by Salim's taswir khana at Allahabad are an indication of the changes that occurred in this city during the five years of the prince's rebellion. He introduced courtly culture into the region, and extended the influence of the Mughal Empire by bringing the area between Patna in the east and Kannauj in the west firmly within his power. Salim's court became a haven for officers who were disaffected with service within either Akbar's court, or Daniyal's, and talented men such as Abu'l Hasan Mashhadi and Khan Jahan Lodi joined the prince's entourage. As Munis Faruqui has explained it, princely rebellion and competition brought about after ending the appanage system thus actually helped in consolidating Mughal influence. It made the princes work harder at forming lasting alliances and helped spread Mughal culture into sub-imperial regions. The impact may have created minor tremors from time to time but made the Mughal Empire stronger and more dynamic, for in the end, whether it was Salim or Akbar who emerged victorious, it was always going to be Mughal power that benefitted.

As news of Salim's rebellion grew more insistent Akbar decided, somewhat reluctantly, to return to his capital. The Mughal army left the Deccan in April 1601 but, outside Ujjain, Akbar made a detour to visit a hermit who had begun to gather a potent reputation for asceticism and wisdom. This was the hermit referred to by Jahangir in his memoirs as Jadrup, identified by Moosvi as one Chitrarupa, a Nagar Brahmin from Gujarat. According to the detailed description left by Jahangir, Chitrarupa lived in a tiny pit dug out of a hill, where he lived in complete darkness and solitude. 'He spends his time alone in that dark narrow hole,' wrote Jahangir admiringly. 'In winter and cold weather, although he is absolutely naked and has no clothing except a piece of rag with which he covers himself in front and behind, he never lights a fire.' Chitrarupa only left his cave to bathe in a river and to go once a day to a chosen Brahmin's house in Ujjain where he contented himself with eating five morsels of food, which he swallowed hurriedly so as to derive no enjoyment from it. Of his philosophy, Jahangir wrote that he 'had excellently mastered the science of (Vedanta), which is the science of tasawwuf ', through which statement Jahangir shows that he regarded Muslim mysticism as a pantheistic doctrine